BEY0ND C0DE C0LLECT1VE

SIX MONTH IMPACT REPORT

[FALL 2026]



[A LETTER FROM US]

THE FUTURE BELONGS TO ALL OF US.

A year ago, Beyond Code Collective was an idea. Today it is a 71-year-old woman in Atlanta telling anyone who will listen that she now knows how to sit down and build a workflow using AI. It is a man who spent nearly two decades playing professional basketball, getting certified in Information Technology fundamentals and then supporting a cohort of retiring athletes behind him. It is a mother of two, job-hunting full time, who told us this was the first room where she believed she belonged.

That's who this report is about. Not us — them.*

We launched in March 2026, and this report covers our first six months of programs. What follows is a young organization's honest ledger: real numbers and real names. What worked, what we learned, and what we're working to prove *with* the community.

What we can tell you, before you get to a single chart, is that the model holds. People show up. They stay. They teach each other. And when we ask what actually changed things for them, the answer is rarely the curriculum alone. It's that someone built a room that expected something of them.

Thank you for following along, and we hope you'll join in.

— The Beyond Code Team

*There's a popular theory that the em dash, —, is a clear giveaway for AI writing. It isn't always a sign of AI—our team loves an em dash and refuses to stop using it!

[WHO WE ARE]

BEYOND CODE COLLECTIVE IS A PLACE-BASED NONPROFIT BUILDING INTERGENERATIONAL OPPORTUNITY IN THE TECHNOLOGIES OF TODAY AND TOMORROW.

We believe learning is stronger when it is intergenerational. At Beyond Code Collective, youth, caregivers, wisdom leaders (55+), and working adults learning side by side, at any age and any starting point.

Our work bridges the gap between inspiration, training, and employment in tech, connecting learners of all ages and backgrounds to accessible education, hands-on opportunities to build with emerging technologies, and clear pathways to launch and grow meaningful careers.



[WHAT WE DO]

HOW PEOPLE EXPERIENCE BEYOND CODE.

COMMUNITY LEARNING

BEYOND CODE CENTERS

Intergenerational, site-specific hubs blending tech education, community engagement, and workforce development.

Storytelling, entrepreneurship, and creative-technology programming are rooted in local needs—we know confidence grows when learners see their lived experiences reflected in the space, curriculum, and facilitators.

Centers are built *with* community, not for them.

WORKFORCE TRAINING

BEYOND CODE CATALYST

Cohort-based workforce program for adults 18+, no tech background required, hands-on learning, credentials, and wraparound support.

We teach practical, job-facing skills like applied AI, business fundamentals, and workplace tools as we believe a build-based approach is integral to learning.

Every program has a live instructor, portfolio-development and opportunities to connect with industry professionals.

GLOBALLY

CODE ALONG BEYOND

Free, video-based, self-paced YouTube series for all.

We bring tech learning to anyone, anywhere. Our first season, *Code Along Beyond: Music*, launched with support from Apple and pairs technical skills with creative expression because technology and culture are inseparable.

[BY THE NUMBERS]

OUR REACH IN THE FIRST SIX MONTHS.

485

learners served across the Atlanta Center and Catalyst programs combined, in five months

310

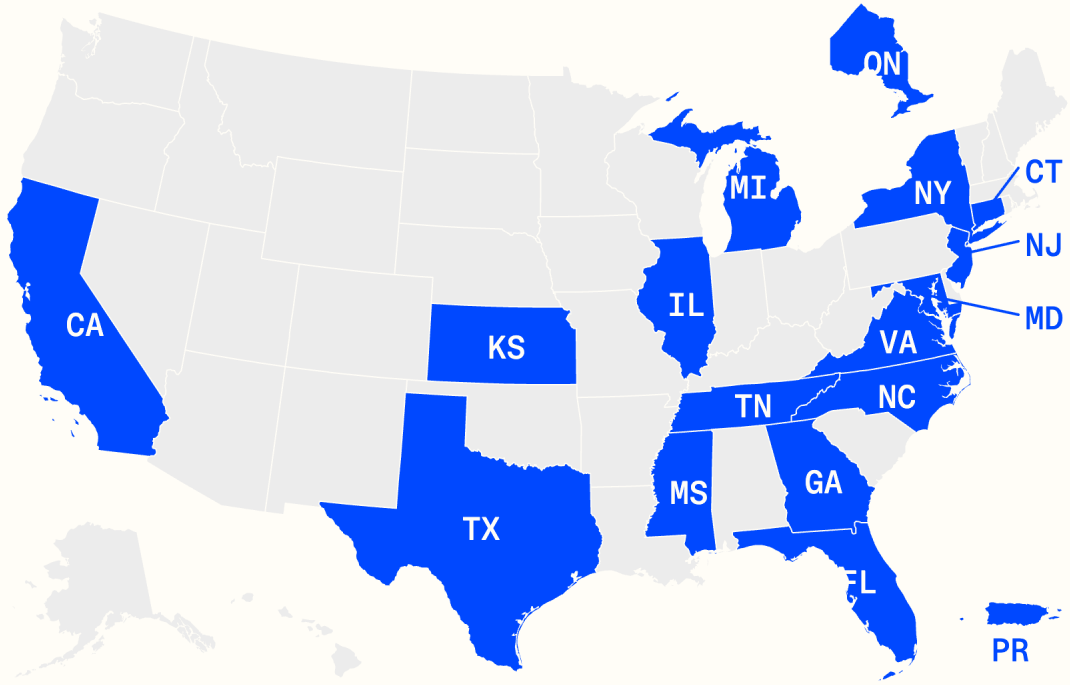
Atlanta residents served in the first four months of the residency

175

Catalyst completions to date

2.3M

views of Code Along Beyond: Music in its first month (and climbing) across Youtube and social media.



Beyond Code has reached learners in 16 U.S. states and territories, and one Canadian province.

[SUCCESS TO DATE: FIRST SIX MONTHS]

LEARNER OUTCOMES.

A sample of our participants' outcomes below. All figures are self-reported from pre-, mid-, and post-program surveys, using a 5-point Likert scale.

80%

of Center learners reported increased confidence with technology.

92%

of Home for the Summer (Catalyst) participants said they can now see themselves succeeding in a tech career — the remaining 8% already did.

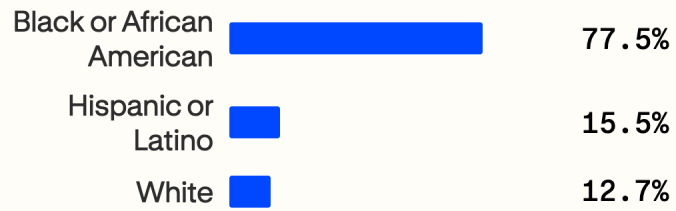
100%

of Center learners taught what they learned to someone else. The best way to learn is to teach.

[WHO WE SERVE]

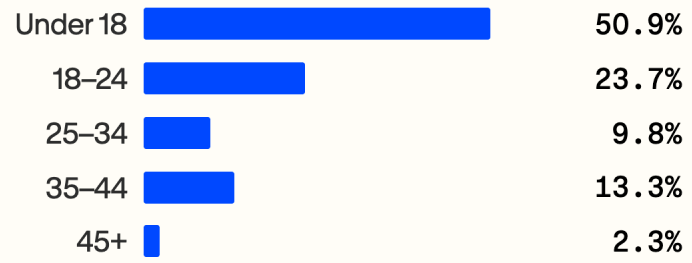
DEMOGRAPHICS.

RACE AND ETHNICITY



Asian, Middle Eastern or North African, American Indian or Alaska Native, another race, and prefer not to say: fewer than 5 each.

SIX GENERATIONS IN THE ROOM



LANGUAGE AND ACCESS

100%
speak English

11.3%
speak Spanish

7.0%
speak another language

12.7%
report a disability

GENDER

60.6%
women

38.0%
men

FIRST-GENERATION COLLEGE

26.8%

of learners are the first in their family to attend college.

[WHO WE SERVE]

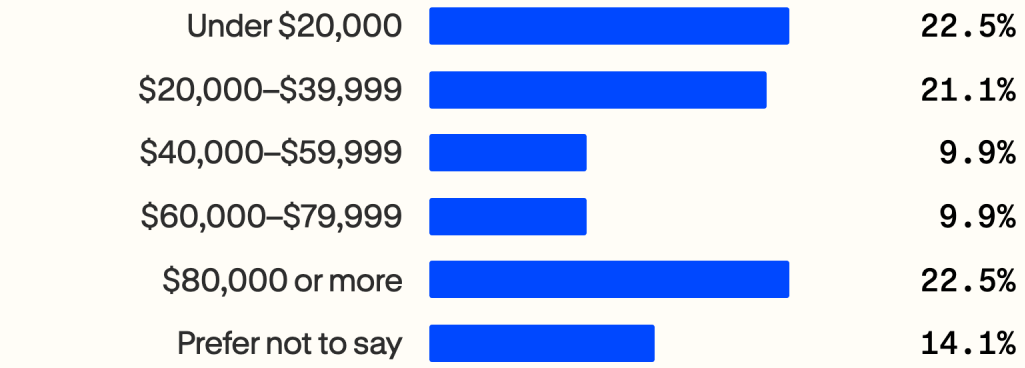
DEMOGRAPHICS, CONTINUED.

ECONOMIC ACCESS

43.6%

of households report making under $40,000 a year

ANNUAL HOUSEHOLD INCOME AT ENROLLMENT

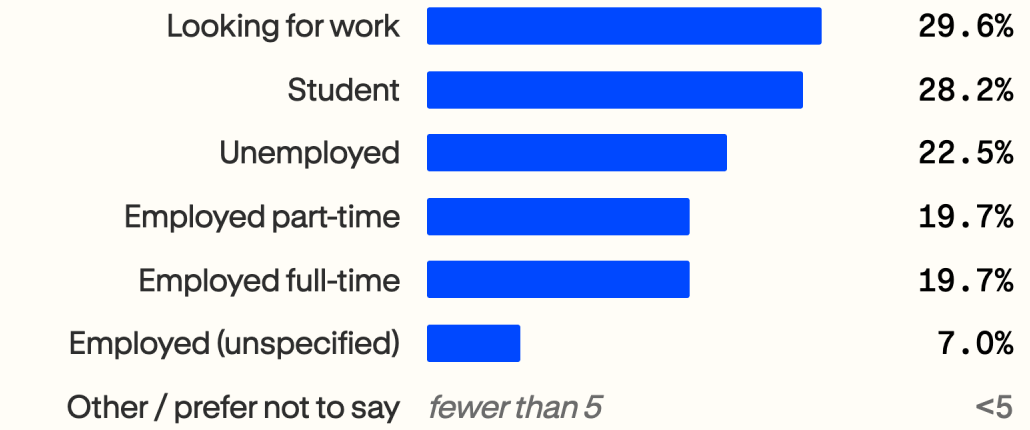


WHERE PEOPLE ARE STARTING FROM

29.6%

arrive already searching for a job

EMPLOYMENT STATUS AT ENROLLMENT





[SUCCESS STORIES]

“In my experience in this course, I have learned about the fundamentals of AI and how to use AI in my everyday life... I have enjoyed my experience so far.”

— SHENIYA, PARENT AND PROGRAM PARTICIPANT: AI FUNDAMENTALS FOR DIGITAL NATIVS

“This program has given me confidence in ways I did not think were even possible.”

— TY, PROGRAM PARTICIPANT: HOME FOR THE SUMMER

“I realized everybody’s second-guessing themselves... and I've now come to believe I belong in tech.”

— KAREN, PROGRAM PARTICIPANT: CYBERSECURITY

[IN THE FIELD]

In the first six months since our launch,Catalyst learners have already landed work and credit our support. One, from our IT-to-cybersecurity track, joined the tech administration team at a college. The other, a single mom who recently returned to school and participated in our program, Home for the Summer, secured a consulting contract she attributes to our mindset coaching.

PARTNERSHIP HIGHLIGHTS

[PROGRAM SPOTLIGHT]

CITY OF ATLANTA DEPARTMENT OF LABOR

A 10-seat, 8-week pilot with the City's ADOLES program. The small size was intentional: the City's ADOLES team knew the hurdles these out-of-school young adults face and wanted to test appetite before scaling.

Learners started with the fundamentals of AI, then moved into a hands-on build phase where they applied those skills to develop a project of their own.

10
registered

5
started build phase

100%
reported increased confidence

[WHO THE COHORT WAS]

33% would be the first in their family to finish college · 83% from households earning under $40,000 a year

[GRADUATE SPOTLIGHT]



KIANDRA

Georgia Tech grad, mechanical engineering background; came in never having opened vibe coding tools, now runs it comfortably and uses it in Reinvend, her own startup modernizing vending with fresh local meals.

[PROGRAM SPOTLIGHT]

NEXTERA ENERGY

Home for the Summer is a week-long intensive for undergraduates in the last stretch of summer, right before classes resume and intern application season begins. Offered in partnership with NextEra Energy, it blended workplace-fundamentals learning with mentorship and career navigation.

Over the week, participants built and presented an AI-assisted capstone. In closing surveys, participants reported gains in every skill area, with the biggest jump in Work Readiness.

20
participants

100%
showed growth across all five skill areas

100%
built and presented an AI-assisted capstone

[SKILL AREAS MEASURED]

AI at Work · Mindset & Professional Identity · Work Readiness · Workplace Tools Fluency · Professional Presence

[GRADUATE SPOTLIGHT]



ZACHARY

“This program pushed me outside of my comfort zone and showed me that I’m capable of learning and applying new technology much faster than I expected.”

[BUILD SPOTLIGHT · SERPENTINE GALLERIES]

I DIDN'T REALISE YOU THOUGHT LIKE THAT

This year the Beyond Code team also took on a major product build outside our own programs and proprietary learning experience platform: a commission from London's Serpentine Gallery, supported by the Glass Castle Foundation.

Built with artist Danielle Brathwaite-Shirley, it is an online game exploring polarization through critical play, an extension of her multiplayer project THE DELUSION (presented at Serpentine North, September 2025 to January 2026).

And we had the honor of presenting it at the 2026 Games for Change Festival.

NOTE: TOUCHES MATURE SUBJECT MATTER AND STRONG LANGUAGE.



IMAGE COURTESY THE ARTIST

[PLAY THE GAME]

ididntrealiseyouthoughtlikethat.com



[WHERE WE'RE GOING]

THE FIRST SIX MONTHS PROVED THE APPROACH WORKS.

The next year is about how many rooms we can open, and how far each one carries someone. We would like you in it.

FIELD READY

Our next workforce track: a rolling cohort model that trains people with no coding background to scope, build, and defend real AI-powered work. First invite-only cohort before end of year; open enrollment for January 2027 beginning soon.

MORE BEYOND CODE CENTERS, COAST TO COAST

New York, South Florida, Los Angeles, Bay Area, Puerto Rico, and more.

[JOIN US]

A FEW WAYS TO PLUG IN.

BRING A BEYOND CODE CENTER TO YOUR CITY

Beyond Code Centers are intergenerational, site-specific hubs that blend tech education, community engagement, and workforce development. Join us as a community, delivery, or funding partner to bring a Beyond Code Center to your city — reach out to learn more!

SUPPORT BEYOND CODE CATALYST

Drive employee engagement through informational interviews or guest-speaking slots that keep Beyond Code Catalysts up to date on industry happenings, or partner with us to deliver a cohort, with first-chance opportunities to hire within your own organization across a wide range of experience levels. We also design custom professional development for organizations looking to upskill their own staff in emerging tech.

BUILD SOMETHING WITH US

Looking to develop a project and need a team to assemble quickly to scope and develop it? Our team builds products in addition to programs, and we bring on Beyond community members to build whenever possible. Let's work together.


THANK YOU.
partnerships@wearebcc.org